

Homebrew “Mythic Japan”

Following my quest for a Homebrew “Mythic Japan” setting for Mythras, I translated the material from <https://elruneblog.blogspot.com/> and completed it with other sources.

It’s heavily based on the Legend supplement of Mongoose publishing “Samurai of Legend”

Character creation for “Mythic Japan” with Mythras

Instead of determining starting skill (standard and professional) from **culture**, they are applied by general caste (standard) and by specific caste (professional).

The general caste is nobility (**ryōmin**) or commoners (**heimin**). These two are divided into the various specific castes that make up the historical social structure of Medieval Japan

The **ryōmin** caste is further divided into the following castes:

- **kuge** : imperial court aristocracy
- **buke** : military aristocracy, also named samurai.

The **heimin** caste, on the other hand, regroup the following castes (with higher status one first in the list):

- **Kōnin** : servants and merchants
- **heimin** : peasants, artisans and merchants, gardeners
- **hinin or eta** : butchers, tanners, gravediggers, itinerants artists, and outcasts (beggars, criminals, and Shinobi)

Religious people are outside the caste system and can belong to any of them.

Castes : giving skills like cultures

Ryōmin : nobility

Standard skills :

Stamina, Athletics, Deceive, Perception, First Aid, Region and choose between Rowing or Driving.

Kuge: imperial court aristocracy

Professional skills :

Art, Bureaucracy, Courtesy, Reading/Writing (Japanese), Public Speaking, Music, Lore (any), other Lore (any) or Read/Write (Chinese).

Kuge caste combat styles:

- Kuge: tachi, tantō; trait: Cautious fighter.
- Buddhist religious: fight, shakujō; trait: Improved Surrender
- Shinto religious: fight, daikyu; trait: Improved Surrender.

Cultural passions:

Honor (personal): 30% + POW+ INT

Love (clan): 30% + POW+ INT.

Buke :military aristocracy, also named samurai (侍).

Professional skills :

Art, Bureaucracy, Courtesy, Teaching, Reading/Writing, Navigation, Lore (any),
Public speaking.

Samurai caste fighting styles (asterisk indicates low-ranking samurai styles):

- Samurai: katana, wakizashi, yari, daikyu, tantō, (teppō); trait: Mounted Combat.
- Samurai scout : katana, wakizashi, yari, daikyu, tantō; trait: Mounted skirmisher.
- Samurai wife: naginata, aiguchi; trait: Cautious fighter.
- Ashigaru*: yari, katana, wakizashi, tantō, daikyu, (teppō); trait: Formation fighting.
- Dōshin* (policeman): jitte, hachiwara, katana, sasumata, sodegarami, tsukubō; trait: Mancatcher.
- Sōhei (warrior monk): naginata, katana, daikyu, tantō; trait: Solid stance.
- Buddhist religious: fight, shakujobō; trait: Improved Surrender
- Shinto religious: fighting, daikyu; trait: Improved Surrender
- Shugenja/Yamabushi: bō, katana, fuetsu, onō; trait: Unarmed prowess.

Cultural passions:

Honor (personal): 30% + POW+ INT

Loyalty (daimyo): 30% + POW+ CHA

Love (clan): 30% + POW+ INT

Heimin : commoners

Standard skills :

Stamina, Custom, Deceit, Influence, Influence, Riding, Insight and Will.

Kōnin : servants and merchants

Professional skills :

Art, Crafts (any), Bureaucracy, Bureaucracy, Street, Trading, Courtesy, Reading/Writing,
Knowing (any).

Combat styles of the Kōnin caste:

- Ashigaru: yari, katana or wakizashi, tantō; trait: Formation fighting.
- Ashigaru archer: daikyu, tantō; trait: Formation fighting.
- Ashigaru arquebusier: teppō., tantō; trait: Formation fighting.
- Armed citizen: wakizashi, jō, tantō; trait: Cautious fighter.

Cultural passions:

Loyalty (samurai family he serves): 30% + POW+ CHA of head of household.

Love (person, family): 30% + POW+ CHA of the person

Nōmin : peasants, artisans and merchants, gardeners

Professional skills :

Crafts (any), Crafting (any), Street, Trade, Courtesy, Influence, Gambling, Lore (any),
Survival.

Combat styles of the Nômin caste:

- Ashigaru: yari, katana or wakizashi, tantō; trait: Formation fighting.
- Ashigaru archer: daikyu, tantō; trait: Formation fighting.
- Ashigaru arquebusier: teppō., tantō; trait: Formation fighting.
- Bandit: masakari, nodachi, katana or wakizashi, tetsubō, manrikigusari, tekkō. trait: Intimidating Scream (Formation)
- Peasant: kama, ōkama, stone; trait: defensive minded.
- Armed citizen: wakizashi, jō, tantō; trait: Cautious fighter.
- Dōshin (policeman): jitte, hachiwara, katana, sasumata, sodegarami, tsukubō; trait: Mancatcher.
- Buddhist religious: fight, shakujōbō; trait: Improved Surrender
- Shinto religious: fighting, daikyu; trait: Improved Surrender.
- Shinobi: ninjatō, tantō, kusarigama, hankyu, sai, nunchaku, nekode, shuriken; trait: Assassination.
- Shugenja/Yamabushi: bō, katana, fuetsu, onō; trait: Unarmed prowess.
- Sōhei (warrior monk): naginata, katana, daikyu, tantō; trait: Solid stance.

Cultural passions:

Loyalty to the village/town: 30% + POW+ INT.

Honor (work): 30% + POW+ INT

Love/Hate (person, clan, family): 30% + POW+ INT

Hinin : butchers, tanners, gravediggers, itinerants artists, and outcasts (beggars, criminals, and Shinobi)

Professional skills :

Crafts (any), Crafting (any), Street, Trade, Courtesy, Influence, Gambling, Lore (any), Survival.

Combat styles of the hinin caste:

- Marginal: jō, tantō, throwing stone; trait: Cautious fighter.
- Bandit: katana, wakizashi, nodachi, masakari, tetsubō, manrikigusari, tekkō; trait: Intimidating Scream (Formation).
- Shinobi: ninjatō, tantō, kusarigama, hankyu, sai, nunchaku, nekode, shuriken; trait: Assassination.

Cultural passions:

Honor (work): 30% + POW+ INT

Love/Hate (person, clan, family): 30% + POW+ INT

Using castes for character creation

You must unlock three professional skills from the list of your specific caste.

You may choose one combat style from your caste, in addition to Fighting. Remember that teppō is only part of the samurai, ashigaru or sōhei fighting style as of 1543 and at the discretion of the master.

You have 100 points to distribute between the standard skills per generic caste and the three professional skills you have selected per caste.

You must assign to each of them between 5 and 15 points.

In addition, add +40% to Customs and Native Language (Japanese).

Careers:

Careers by castes

Careers are limited by specific caste:

- Kuge: imperial courtier, gakusha (scholar), sō (Buddhist priest), bōzu/ama (monk/nun)
- Buddhist, kannushi (Shinto priest), shugenja (ascetic), onmyōji (sorcerer).
- Samurai: bushi (warrior), isha (physician), courtier (samurai focused on administrative duties), hyakushō (lowly jizamurai), hangan (magistrate in charge of the administration and justice of a town or city), daishon (samurai focused on administrative tasks), daishonin (official in the court of a daimio), gakusha (scholar), onmyōji (sorcerer), dōshin (policeman in the service of the magistrate), sō (Buddhist priest), bōzu/ama (Buddhist monk/nun), kannushi (Shinto priest).
- Kenin: meshitsukai (servant), gakusha (scholar), bushi (warrior), onmyōji (sorcerer).
- Heimin: hyakushō (peasant), ryōshi (fisherman), shokunin (craftsman), akindo (merchant), bushi (warrior), hangan (magistrate of a small town or village), baishunfu (prostitute), reijin (artist), nusubito (thief), dōshin (low-ranking policeman), sō (Buddhist priest), bōzu/ama (Buddhist monk/nun), kannushi (Shinto shrine keeper), shugenja (ascetic), karyudo (hunter), miner.
- Hinin: shokunin (gardener or impure professions such as tanner, butcher or undertaker), shinobi, nusubito (thief), reijin (itinerant artist), baishunfu (prostitute), karyudo (hunter), ryōshi (fisherman), sō (Buddhist priest), bōzu/ama (Buddhist monk/nun).

Note on the bushi career and associated status

- If the character is noble and under the orders of a daimyo, he is a samurai warrior or an ashigaru if he is one of a poor clan;
- if he is part of the common people, he is an ashigaru or a yojimbo (bodyguard);
- if he travels on a muso shugyo (martial arts apprenticeship trip) he is a shugyosha.
- if he is under the orders of the abbot of a Buddhist monastery or temple, he is a sōhei or warrior monk.

All these careers give the same skills, but differ in their interaction with the world.

Sources for rules related to Careers

- **Akindo**: same as the Merchant profession in Mythras, but replace Riding with Hiding or Perception.
- **Baishunfu**: same as the Mythras Courtesan profession.
- **Bōzu/Ama**: same as the Mystic profession of Mythras.

- **Bushi:** Same as the Warrior profession in Mythras. If a martial master, replace Craft with Teach.
- **Courtier:** same as the Courtier profession in Mythras.
- **Daishonin:** same as the Scholar profession of Mythras.
- **Dōshin:** same as the Warrior profession of Mythras, but replace Endurance with Insight, Combat Style (specialty) with Stealth, and Lore (Military History) for Streetwise.
- **Gakusha:** same as the Scholar profession of Mythras, with Language (Chinese or Korean) and Lore (Poetry, Chinese Literature or Buddhist Theology), Chinese Literature or Buddhist Theology, for example).
- **Hangan:** same as the Official profession of Mythras, but change Trade for Streetwise.
- **Hyakushō:** same as the Farmer profession of Mythras, but replace Ride with Sing.
- **Isha:** same as Mythras Alchemist profession, but replace Craft with Lore (Herbs), Language for Lore (Medicines) and Lore (specific alchemical specialty) for Lore (Poisons).
- **Kannushi:** same as the Priest profession of Mythras, but replace Devotion and Exhortation for Binding and Trance, which are renamed to “Speak with the kami” and “See the unseen world”.
- **Onmyōji:** same as the Sorcerer profession of Mythras, with Language (Chinese) and Lore(Astrology).
- **Nusubito:** same as the Thief profession of Mythras.
- **Reijin:** same as the Entertainer profession in Mythras, but should focus on Musician-ship, Dance, Poetry, and Sing (avoid physical skills such as Athletics, Brawn, and Acrobatics).
- **Ryōshi:** same as the Fisher profession in Mythras.
- **Shinobi:** same as the Agent profession in Mythras, but replace Culture by Meditation and Combat style (concealable weapons) by Combat Style (Shinobi).
- **Shokunin:** same as the Crafter profession of Mythras.
- **Shugenja/Yamabushi:** same as the Mystic profession.

Using professions for character creation

Unlock up to three skills from the professional skills available for the chosen career. A career fighting style can be chosen if available.

Distribute 100 points between the standard career skills, the chosen professional skills and the career fighting style, awarding a minimum of zero points and a maximum of 15 points to each skill.

Equipment

Melee weapons

Type	Weapon	Damage	Size	Reach	Combat effects	ENC	AP/HP	Traits	Cost
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Swords	Katana / Tachi	1d8 (1d10 2H)	M	L	Bleed, Impale	2	6/12		8-10b
	Wakizachi 1H	1d6	M	S	Bleed, Impale	1	6/8		4b
	Nodachi 2H	2d8	H	VL	Bleed, Impale, sunder	3	6/12	Set	4b
	Ninjatô 1/2H	1d6+1 (1d8+1 2H)	M	S	Bleed, Impale	2	6/12		4b
Daggers	Tantô/Aiguchi 1H	1d6	S	T	Bleed, Impale	1	5/7	Thrown	1b
	Sai 1H	1d4+1	S	S	Impale	1	4/7	Entrapping	4m
Spears	Yari 2H	1d10+1	L	VL	Impale	2	4/10	Set	8m
	Nageryari 1H	1d8+1	M	L	Impale	1	4/5	Thrown, Set	6m
	Naginata 2H	2d6	L	VL	Bleed, Impale, Sunder	3	4/10	Set	2b
	Nagamaki 2H	1d8+2	L	VL	Bleed, Impale, Sunder	3	4/12	Set	1b
	Sasumata 2H	1d8+1	L	VL	Impale, Stun location	2	4/10	Entrapping	1b
Blunt	Bokken 1/2M	1d6 (1d8 2H)	M	M	Stun location	1	3/6		3m
	Bo 2H	1d8	M	L	Stun location	2	4/8		3m
	Jo 1H	1d6	M	S	Stun location	1	2/4		1m
	Tonfa 1H	1d4+1	S	S	Stun location, flurry	1	3/4		3m
	Sodegarami 2H	1d8	L	VL	Stun location	2	4/10	Entrapping	6m
	Tsukubô 2H	1d8	L	VL	Stun location, bash	2	4/9	Entrapping	6m
	Testubô 2H	2d8	H	VL	Stun location, bash, sunder	4	4/11		6m
	Nunchaku 1H	1d4+1	M	S	Stun location, flurry	1	3/5	Flexible, defensive	2m
	Tessen 1H	1d4	M	S	Stun location	0	3/5	Defensive	4m
	Kiseru 1H	1d4	S	S	Stun location	1	2/3	Defensive	4m
	Jitte 1H	1d6	S	S	Stun location	1	5/8	Defensive, Entrapping	4m
	Hachiwara 1H	1d6+1	M	S	Stun location	1	5/8	Defensive, Entrapping	7m
Axes	Fuestu 1H	1d6	S	S	Bleed	1	3/6	Thrown	4m

	Masakari 1/2H	1d6+1 (1d8+1 2H)	M	M	Bleed, Sunder	1	4/8		1b
	Ôno 2H	2d6+2	L	VL	Bleed, sunder	2	4/8		2b
Tools	Kama 1H	1d6	M	S	Bleed	1	3/7		2m
	Nagagama 1H	1d6+1	L	L	Bleed	1	3/7		10m
	Ôgama 2H	2d6	M	L	Bleed, sunder	3	5/10		1b
Chains	Manrik-gusari 1H	1d6	M	M-L	Stun location, Entangle	1	6/8	Flexible	4m
Fists	Tekkô	1d3+2	S	T	Stun location, flurry	0	4/5	Defensive	5m
	Nekode/Tekagi	1d4+1	S	S	Bleed, Flurry	0	3/5	Defensive	5m

Distance weapons

Type	Weapon	Dam age	Dam Mod	Force	Range	Load	Combat effects	Impale Size	EN C	AP/H P	Cost
Bows	Daikyu/Yumi	1d8	Y	H	15/125/180	2	Impale	S	2	4/7	8b
	Hankyu	1d6	Y	L	10/35/70	2	Impale	S	1	4/4	1b
Darts	Uchine	1d4	Y	S	5/10/20		Impale	S	0	2/1	6m
	Shuriken	1d3	Y	-	5/10/20		Impale	S	0	2/1	1m
Javelins	Nageyari	1d8	Y	L	10/15/30		Impale	M	1	4/5	6m
Daggers	Tantô/aiguchi	1d4	Y	S	5/10/20		Impale	S	1	4/6	1b
Axes	Fuersu	1d6	Y	S	10/20/30		Bleed	-	1	4/6	4m
Guns	Teppô	1d10	N	H	15/50/300	4	Firearm	-	3	4/7	50b
	Ôdeppô	2d6	N	H	10/20/80	4	Firearm	-	5	5/10	200b
Impro.	Stone	1d3	Y	S	5/25/50		Stun location	-	-	-	-

Armors

Armor during the Sengoku era evolved greatly with the advent of firearms from 1543 onwards

Before that time, lamellar armor predominated.

Later, steel breastplates capable of resisting gunfire began to appear.

Materials:

Armors are made of steel and leather, and are lacquered to prevent moisture. Even the chain mails are lacquered. Therefore, 0.75 per steel has been applied to the ENC.

Barding:

Horses do not wear any kind of armor in battle, except for a metal or leather mask on the head, usually with a leather head mask, usually in the shape of a dragon's head, which provides 5 AP.

High-ranking Samurai

Name	Localization	AP	ENC	Cost	Penalty
Full armor	All		35	280m	-7
Kabuto (lamellar)	Head	7	6	20m	-2
Dô (bulletproof)	Chest, Abdomen	8	9*2	60m	-6
Sode & Kote	Arm	6	5*2	23m	-1
Haidate & Suneate	Leg	7	6*2	37m	-1

Standard Samurai and Sohei

Name	Localization	AP	ENC	Cost	Penalty
Full armor	All		29	204m	-6
Kabuto (lamellar)	Head	7	6	14m	-1
Dô (lamellar)	Chest, Abdomen	6	5*2	30m	-2
Sode & Kote	Arm	6	5*2	21m	-1
Haidate & Suneate	Leg	7	6*2	37m	-2

Ashigaru

Name	Localization	AP	ENC	Cost	Penalty
Full armor	All		17	98m	-4
Jingasa (cap)	Head	5	5	9m	-1
Dô (lamellar)	Chest,	4	3*2	18m	-1

	Abdomen				
Kote	Arm	4	3*2	6m	-1
Haidate & Suneate	Leg	4	3*2	10m	-1

Mail clothes

(can be concealed under clothes; armor for doing shinobi missions)

Name	Localization	AP	ENC	Cost	Penalty
Full armor	All		27	30m	-6
Jingasa (cap)	Head	6	5	5m	-1
Tunic	Chest, Abdomen, leg	6	5*4	20m	-4
sleeve	Arm	6	5*2	10m	-1

Other armors

Name	Localization	AP	ENC	Cost	Penalty
Happuri	chest (only front)	3	1	3m	0
Hachigane	chest (only front)	2	1	2m	0

Buddhist Magic

Buddhist typical cult

Buddhism is a philosophical and religious doctrine that originated in India around the 5th century B.C. by Siddhartha Gautama (better known in Japan as Sakyamuni). It spread throughout East Asia and officially arrived in Japan in 552 AD.

Buddhist doctrine focuses on the elimination of ignorance, which causes suffering, in order to attain enlightenment and perfect happiness. Enlightenment or awakening is a state of complete discernment in which space and time, life and death are transcended. It is sometimes called "nirvana", a state of perfect peace of mind free of ignorance, greed and hatred. Human beings who attain it are called "Buddhas". Attaining this state is difficult and may require countless lifetime, during which the soul is reincarnated. Performing bad deeds

bad karma, which delays progress, while good deeds confer good karma, which accelerates the process. Upon attaining Buddhahood, the soul is freed from the eternal cycle of life, death and reincarnation, and it is possible to attain nirvana. Instead, some Buddhas prefer to remain in the material world to help other people to become Buddhas. The teachings of Buddhism are preserved in sacred texts called sutras.

Requirements

- Be of adult age

Duties

- Follow Buddhist doctrine to the best of one's ability
- Doing good deeds to accumulate good karma and approach enlightenment

Skills and magical traditions

Customs, Devotion or Meditation, Exhort or Mysticism, Influence, Reading/Writing (Japanese, Chinese, Sanskrit), Oratory, Willpower.

Ranks and privileges

1. **Believer**: Equivalent to “lay member” according to RQ6 rules. In exchange for an appropriate donation at a temple or festival in honor of an appropriate Buddhist deity, the believer may learn a prayer (common magic incantation) available at the temple.
2. **Believer in spiritual retreat** : a believer or devotee who lives temporarily in a temple and participates in the ceremonies to learn and deepen his or her knowledge of Buddhist doctrine. They are usually retired nobles, samurai widows or anyone who can afford to cut ties with their family and obligations to get away for a few months or years from the hustle and bustle of the world.
3. **Devotee**: Equivalent to “initiate” of the rules of RQ6. A believer who has vowed to live according to Buddhist precepts (see p. 13). Depending on the Buddhist school of which he is a part, he may learn mystical talents (if he has Meditation and Mysticism skills) or the miracles available to devotees of a Buddhist deity (if he has the Devotion and Exhort skills).
4. **Novice apprentice**: believer who lives in a temple and takes care of maintenance tasks such as cleaning and sweeping while learning Buddhist doctrine and attending ceremonies.
 - a. Requirements: abandon his family, possessions and social caste, swear to follow the Buddhist precepts (pg. 13) and the rules of temple life, shave his head periodically and wear the habit.
5. **Veteran apprentice**: apprentice that spent sufficient time learning Buddhist doctrine and attending ceremonies.
 - a. Requirements: Have been a novice apprentice for at least 2 years. Devotion or Meditation 50%, Read/Write Chinese or Sanskrit 40% and three other cult skills at 40%.
 - b. May learn one miracle or talent every two years, depending on their school.
6. **Sō or bōzu/ama** (priests or monks and nuns in general). Equivalent to the rank of “acolyte” in RQ6.

- a. Requirements: Have been a veteran apprentice for at least 4 years and have 60% or higher in Devotion or Meditation and in three other cult skills.
 - b. May learn one miracle/talent per year.
- 7. **Master** (sō or veteran bōzu with one or more apprentices under him). Equivalent to the rank of “priest” according to the rules of RQ6.
 - a. Requirements: Have been a priest for at least 5 years,
 - b. Have 75% or higher in Devotion or Meditation and in two other cult skills.
- 8. **Sōjō** (head priest of a temple or abbot of a monastery). With enough connection, It is possible to be appointed abbot for purely political interests and not for his merits. In this case the requirements do not need to be fulfilled, but negotiations with higher up is necessary.
 - a. Requirements (for normal promotion): Have been a teacher for at least 5 years. Influence or Oratory 80%.
- 9. **Leader of a school branch:** priest who starts a new branch of the school to which he belongs.
 - a. Requirements: Obtain permission from the leader of the Buddhist school and erect a major temple at least 100 km away from his current temple.
- 10. **Leader of a new Buddhist school:** priest who, after years of study and meditation, acquires an understanding of Buddhism with different facets than those existing to date. Equivalent to the rank "high priest" according to the rules of RQ6.
 - a. Requirements: Have been a priest for at least 10 years and have Devotion or Meditation and one other cult skill at 100%.
- 11. **Buddha (bosatsu):** an awakened human being.
 - a. Requirements: Not committing any transgression in his entire life. Devotion or Meditation 180%, Exhort or Mysticism 100%, Insight 110%, Perception 100%, Passion (Helping others to attain enlightenment) 50% (base % = INT+POU).
 - b. Acquire the gift of Enlightenment. The gift of Enlightenment allows you to cast any non-violent Buddhist miracle and talent as many times as you want, without spending magic points.

Mysticism

Nara schools, esoteric schools and zen schools have access to the magic of mysticism. Each skill band also includes the talents of the lower bands. Priests and monks learn the path of enlightenment and warrior monks (sōhei) the path of Fudō fury.

Path of enlightenment:

Meditation level	Accessible Talents
up to 50%	Increase Stamina, Increase Influence, Increase Insight, Increase Perception, Increase First Aid, Increase Will, Improve Fatigue.

51%-70%	Increase Healing, Aura of Peace, Remove Passion, Immunity to Cold, Improve Healing Rate (can also be used on others).
71% or more	Indomitable, Improve Hit Points, Deny Drink, Deny Food, Deny Food, Deny Desire, Improve Healing Rate (can also be used for others). Food, Denial of Earthly Desires, Recall Past Lives, Spiritual Sense, Sense Life. Spiritual, Sense Life.

Path of Fudō's fury:

Meditation level	Accessible Talents
up to 50%	Increase Stamina, Increase Muscle, Increase Will, Aura of Intimidation, Cut Arrows.
51%-70%	Formidable Natural Weapons (p. 304 of RuneQuest 6th edition), Improve Reaction Momentum, Improve Damage Modifier.
71% or more	Improve Action Points, Improve Hit Points.

Adjust power depending on the place of supernatural in your campaign

If you find that the rules of mysticism as described in the main rules are too powerful for your campaign. You can apply the following change: The maximum intensity of talents is equal to one fortieth (1/40) of the Mysticism skill :

- Mysticism between 1% and 40%, the talents have intensity 1.
- Mysticism between 41% and 80%, maximum intensity 2,
- between 81% and 120% maximum intensity 3.

New talents

Remember Past Lives (3 MP)

The first time this talent is used, a random skill must be determined, which the priest will be able to use with a score of 50% for the duration of the talent. Subsequent uses of the talent allow the priest to use the same skill or try to remember another of the same percentage. Each new skill imposes a cumulative difficulty modifier to the Mysticism roll. That is, to remember a second skill, there is a skill, there is a -20% modifier to Mysticism, for the third skill, a -40%, and so on. If the skill is one that the priest already possesses:

- if the skill is below 50%, he replaces the value of the skill by 50%
- if the skill is over 50%, he adds +20% to his skill.

One skill can be recalled per point of intensity.

Remove Passion (2 MP)

This talent works like the miracle of the same name described in the theism section but only on oneself.

Theism

Pure Land schools use theistic magic by having a more devotional approach. The priests of these schools have access to the miracles of the Buddhas revered in their school. Devotees and warrior monks have access to the miracles available to devotees of a Buddhist deity of their school. Each rank also has available the miracles listed for the ranks below it.

There are two miracles common to all deities, for priests and teachers: Exorcism and Long Repose.

Theistic Buddhas

Hachiman

Some Buddhist schools worship this Shinto deity as a manifestation of the Buddhas. She is the deity of war, but also of farmers and fishermen, whom she blesses with good harvests and abundant fishing.

- Folk magic: Bladesharp, Speedart, Pierce, Fanaticism, Bludgeon, Pet (Pigeons), Vigour, Voice.
- Devotees and apprentices: True (Weapon), Berserk, Shield, Sureshot, Fortify, Fear.
- Priests: Blessing of Niō.
- Masters: Bless Crops, Reveal the Nirvana.

Amida

Guardian of the Western Paradise, one of the highest Buddhas. The Jōdo school popularized his cult to bring salvation to the common people. Anyone can attain salvation simply by reciting the name of Amida Buddha: "namu Amida butsu." If he or she does so with true faith, he or she will be reborn in the paradise of the Pure Land. Amida, Kannon and Jizō are the three savior Buddhas of the common people. Amida is prayed to for future life in paradise, Kannon to help those in need in earthly life, and Jizō to protect from terrors of hell.

- Folk magic: Find(temple), Calm, Spiritshield, Protection, Witchsight.
- Devotees and apprentices: Absorption, Spirit Block, Consecrate, Soul Sight.
- Priests: Heal Wound, Dismiss Magic, Bring Peace to the world, gather wisdom.
- Masters: Interpret Mandala (only Shingon and Tendai schools), Reveal the Nirvana, Reflection, Mindlink.

Kannon

Buddha of compassion, patroness of mothers and sailors.

The Lotus Sutra describes her as having the power to alleviate suffering and bestow children. Her thousand arms represent the power of all the gods.

- Folk magic: Find(sickness), Heal, Calm, Heat, Repair.
- Devotees and apprentices: Shield, Heal Wound, Breathe Water (only to targets that are drowning).
- Priests: Fecundity, Heal Body.
- Masters: Cure Malady, Heal Mind, Reveal the Nirvana.

Jizô

Protector of travelers and the souls of the deceased. His statues are very common, especially on roads and in cemeteries. He is also the protector of children, especially the souls of those who die before their parents.

- Folk magic: Alarm, Find(child), Calm, Dishevel, Spiritshield, Pathway.
- Devotees and apprentices: Spirit Block, Consecrate, Fear (only against evil spirits), Soul sight.
- Priests: Heal Wound.
- Masters: Bring Peace to the world, Reveal the Nirvana.

Go-Chi

The Buddha of the five directions, the contemplative Buddha.

Patron of those striving for nirvana: Taho, Yakushi, Dainichi, Askuku and Shaka.

- Folk magic: Find (Temple), Calm, Mindspeech, Witchsight.
- Devotees and apprentices: Spirit Block, Consecrate, Dismiss Magic, Mindlink.
- Priests: Interpret Mandala (Shingon and Tendai schools only), Bring Peace to the world, Gather wisdom.
- Masters: Reveal the Nirvana, Reflection

Emma Ô

Guardian of hell and judge of the dead who decides the fate of the soul: reincarnation, purification of bad karma in hell or return as a spirit to pay a debt.

- Folk magic: Find(transgressor of Buddhist precepts), demoralize.
- Devotees and Apprentices: Absorption, Fear.
- Priests: Extension.
- Masters: Purge Bad Karma.

Inari

A mischievous and troublesome deity, but pure of heart, as she blesses the rice crops. She is worshiped by some Buddhist schools as a manifestation of the Buddha. She is associated with foxes.

- Folk magic: Glamour, Find(food), Warmth, Pet (foxes), Preserve, Vigour.
- Devotees and apprentices: Absorption, Mindlink, Dismiss Magic.
- Priests and masters: Bless Crops.

The Godai Myō-ō

The five great kings of wisdom : Daiitoku, Fudō, Gozanze, Gundari and Kongo-Yasha.

They are emanations of the Buddhas wisdom and represent the power to overcome passions. They can exercise violence to preserve the order of the universe. They are furious beings with great powers over the elements. They are often depicted wrapped in flames, representing the purification of Buddhism by burning all material desires and soul-consuming passions. The most revered is Fudō.

- Folk magic: Befuddle, Bladesharp, Demoralize, Bludgeon, Protection.
- Devotees and apprentices: Absorption, True (Weapon), Berserk, Sureshot, Remove Passion, Fear.
- Priests: Dismiss Elemental, Extension, Blessing of the Myō-ō, Mindlink.
- Masters: Reveal the Nirvana, Purge Evil, Purge Evil Karma.

Santen

The three celestials, Buddhist war deities :

- ❖ **Bishamonten**: god of warriors, healing, and wealth. He is represented with a weapon in one hand and a pagoda in the other, where he keeps the teachings of Buddha. His cult is very common among the sōhei.
- ❖ **Daikokuten**: deity of war and farmers who is represented with a sword or a mace and a sword or a mallet and a sack full of treasures.
- ❖ **Marishiten**: with three faces and several armed arms, on a boar or lotus flower. It personifies the divine and blinding light of the sun. Favored by archers for her ability to become invisible or create mirages to avoid or confuse enemies. She also dispenses wealth and is worshiped by merchants.

- Folk magic: Befuddle, Bladesharp, Demoralize, Bludgeon, Protection.
- Devotees and apprentices: True (Weapon), Chameleon*, Sureshot, Shield, Mirage*, Fortify, Illusion*, Fear.
- Priests and teachers: Blessing of Niō.

* Only while the sun is directly behind the target or illusion.

Shitennō

The four celestial kings, protectors of the 4 directions and the center.

The four heavenly kings protect the nation and its inhabitants from evil and evil spirits. The four are led by Taishakuten, the guardian of the center. They protect the temple and stand around the central Buddha. They usually carry weapons and armor to overcome evil influences and often tread on evil spirits. In esoteric schools they have been replaced by the Five great kings of wisdom.

- Devotees and apprentices: Spirit Block, Dismiss Magic, Shield.

- Priests: Bring Peace to the world.
- Masters: Blessing of the Shitenno, Fear, Reflection.

Dainichi Nyorai

the Great Enlightener, the cosmic Buddha, Buddha of the universe – Biroshanabutsu

- Folk Magic: Might, Calm, Mindspeech, Spiritshield, WitchSight.

This Buddha does not grant theistic miracles, but his teachings are learned through mysticism.

Yakushi

Medicine Buddha, King of the Eastern Pure Land Paradise

One of the first Buddhas historically worshiped in Japan.

- Folk Magic: Find(illness), Find(medicinal plant), Warmth, Calm, Heal, Vigour, Witchsight.
- Devotees and apprentices: Heal Wound.
- Priests: Heal Body, Heal Mind.
- Masters: Cure Malady, Purge Bad Karma, Cure Sense, Rejuvenate.

New miracles

Blessing of Niō

This miracle enchants one of the guardian statues protecting the gates of a Buddhist temple, so that it becomes animated and attacks anyone who wants to harm the temple and its inhabitants. When the duration of the miracle is over, the statue returns to its place. The miracle must be cast again for the statue to be reactivated in the future. Being statues, the Niō are slow, but they do not suffer fatigue nor can they be incapacitated by injuries sustained. They are usually made of colorfully painted wood and sometimes stone.

Characteristics		Attributes		1d20	Localiz.	AP/HP	AP/HP
STR	4d6+12 (26)	AP	2	1-3 4-6	Leg (right left)	8/9	4/9
CON	3d6+9 (18)	Mod. Dam.	1d12	7-9	Abdomen	8/10	4/10
SIZ	4d6+12 (26)	Mouv.	4m	10-12	Chest	8/11	4/11
DEX	1d6+3 (6)	Initi	+7	13-15 16-18	Arm (right left)	8/8	4/8
POW	2d6 (7)	Mag. Pts	11	19-20	Head	8/9	4/9
CHA	3d6 (11)					Stone	Wood

Traits: Formidable Natural Weapons, Immunity (Disease, Poison, Asphyxiation), Night Vision

Skills: Stamina 50%, Brawn 90%, Perception 35%, Stealth 20%, Willpower 45%.

Combat Styles: Sacred Guardian 40% (wood or stone sword, fists and feet)

Weapon	Size	Reach	Damage	Effects	PA/PG
Sword	VL	L	1d8+1d12		5-2/11
Fist and feet	G	M	1d6+d12		8-4/9

Blessing of the Myō-ō / Blessing of the Shitennō

This miracle enchants one of the statues of the Myō-ō or Shitennō of a Buddhist temple, which are usually placed around the main Buddhist deity. The statue will launch a mystical attack on anyone who wants to steal or harm the temple and its inhabitants. This attack is launched against the enemy with a skill of 90%. If the enemy does not succeed in a willpower test, he will remain prostrate on the ground praying for the forgiveness of the Buddhas for the duration of the miracle. In order for the statue to be reactivated in the future the miracle must be cast again.

Interpreting Mandala

In order to request this miracle, the priest must first create a mandala (on a piece of paper or wood or on the floor). He must then contemplate its inner meaning while requesting the Buddhas to grant him temporary enlightenment. If the Exhort roll is successful, a problem or mystery troubling the priest immediately becomes crystalline as he contemplates it through the illusion of reality. The player can get truthful and benevolent answer to a number of question per point of intensity of the miracle.

Reveal the Nirvana

An area around the caster with a radius equal to his POU in meters is illuminated with the light of nirvana, a sacred paradise that lasts as long as the priest maintains concentration. No earthly element, natural disaster or physical attack can penetrate or harm this area or anyone within it. In addition, anyone within the area of effect has their fatigue restored and 1d3 health points healed at each location.

Bring Peace to the world

Like the miracle Pacifism from the RuneQuest 6 rules (page 268). In addition, anyone attempting to damage the miracle's target must pass an opposed roll against the caster's Devotion multiplied by two.

Gather Wisdom

The target of the miracle receives temporary enlightenment and beholds before him all the wisdom of the Buddhas. This allows him to communicate with total eloquence and

conviction. For the duration of the miracle, his Influence and Oratory skills are doubled, and he gains the Buddhist Theology skill with a percentage equal to INT+POU (in case he did not already have this skill).

Purge Bad Karma

Removes the bad karma accumulated by another person who has committed a transgression and shows repentance. Cannot be used on the caster himself. Removes a -5% negative penalty for accumulated bad karma per point of intensity of the miracle.

Remove Passion

For the duration of the miracle, the caster reduces one passion of the target by 20% per point of intensity. If the passion is reduced to 0%, the target must behave as if he does not possess that passion for the duration of the miracle. For example, someone with Hatred of the Oda clan 65% will abandon his intention to harm the Oda clan. Once the miracle is over, a confrontation roll must be made between the affected Passion and the caster's Devotion. If the latter wins, the passion will be reduced by 3d3 points permanently.

Schools of Buddhism

The Buddhist branches of Japan are schools of Buddhist thought. Each of them follows the precepts of the Buddhas, but gives more importance to some aspects than others, similar to the different strands of other great religions. From its beginnings in India, Buddhism spread throughout the East in two major divisions: Mahayana and Theravada. In Japan, most Buddhist schools descended from the Mahayana branch, which, unlike the Theravada, maintains that lay believers can also attain Buddhahood.

Ordinary people do not pay attention to the differences between schools and pray without any problem in a temple of one or the other as it suits them. Only monks and priests have the necessary knowledge to pay attention to these details. And although most schools coexist peacefully, on several occasions they have clashed, even violently, to acquire greater political power or popularity.

Karma balance

Penalty to Exhort or Mysticism due to transgressions

Those who commit bad deeds accumulate bad karma, and this greatly hinders their progress towards enlightenment. A person who accumulates a large amount of bad karma will have to spend time in Buddhist hell after death, and his next life will be full of hardships.

Remorse for wrongdoing affects one's ability to use exhort or mysticism skills, as reflected in the following table. The penalty coming from different actions can cumulate, but each type of action can only lead to one penalty.

Devotees and warrior monks suffer only half of the above.

When the penalty reaches the same level as the level of the skill, the character must pass a Willpower roll, or he will either run to a temple to purge himself. If he is to be blocked to get to a temple, he will enter an uncontrolled panic state.

Transgression	Penalty
Refusing a donation	-20%
Eating meat	
Drinking alcohol	
Insulting someone	
Deliberately lying	
Giving in to greed	
Giving in to pride	
Stealing	-30%
Giving in to lust	
Inflict a wound ^(a)	
Cause death ^(a)	-60%
Desecrate a temple or allow it to be desecrated	
Cursing or dishonoring a Buddha	-300%

(a) Except for evil yōkai and underworld beings such as oni, bakemono, yurei or shikome, among others. But including to himself.

Bad karma

Doing bad deeds attracts misfortunes. Each time the penalized skill reaches 0 or a cumulative penalty of 30% is reached, the character gets one point of bad karma, which is noted as a -1 next to his luck points score on the character sheet.

This modifier reduces the character's luck point pool. In addition, the GM may use that negative luck point to force the player to reroll a successful roll or to reroll a failed roll of a non-player character or impersonal force that is intended to affect the character negatively. Once the game director has used this bad karma point, the negative modifier to the player character's luck points is reduced by one point.

Good karma (see below) and bad karma points cancel each other out.

Purge bad karma

The penalty to skills accumulated by transgressing Buddhist precepts can be removed with the miracle Purge Bad Karma, usually cast by another Buddhist. Another way is to use the skill of Meditation : At the end of a full week spent meditating, a Buddhist can make a Meditation test. If the Buddhist succeeds in the roll, he removes up to 25% of the penalty. If the result of the roll is a critical success, it removes up to 50%.

Good karma

Doing good deeds attracts fortune. When a player character does an action of selfless kindness or has gone many sessions without committing any transgression, the game director may reward him with a point of good karma. This point is recorded next to the luck points on the character sheet as "+1". The player can spend this extra luck point once he has used up his own. Once spent, the good karma point is deleted from the character sheet. If the character has a bad karma point when he gains a good karma point, the two karma points instantly cancel themselves.

Recovery of magic points

To recover the magic points used to cast common magic, talents or miracles, a priest from a Pure Land or Tendai school must pray in his temple, while a priest of the Nara, Shingon or Zen schools must meditate.

While meditating to recover magic points, the Meditation skill does not provide any other advantage.

Action		Magic point recovered
Meditate in a quiet place		1 per hour up to $\frac{1}{4}$ of the max
Prayer or meditation in a minor temple		1 per hour up to $\frac{1}{2}$ of the max
Praying or meditating in a major temple		1 per hour up to $\frac{3}{4}$ of the max
Praying or meditating in a large temple		1 per hour up to the max
Actively participate in a sacred Buddhist festival		All
Making a pilgrimage to a famous temple		All
Donating to a temple or mendicant priest:	More than 1 b	1PM (max once per day)
	More than 1 m	3PM (max once per week)
	more than 5 m	6PM (max once per month)

Ofuda

These talismans are placed at the entrances of homes to prevent the passage of evil spirits that may carry diseases or bad luck. In Shinto tradition, they are strips of paper with the name of a kami and his or her shrine written in ink, or they can be made of wood and have the name engraved on them. In Buddhism, ofuda contain passages from sacred sutras and have the same effect. To obtain one, a donation must be made to the Shinto shrine or a Buddhist temple. They are usually purchased at New Year and their effect lasts for one year.

Create an ofuda

A Shinto priest or Buddhist monk can create these talismans to offer them to people in need, and also to fight evil spirits and ghosts. To create it, the priest or monk must be in a quiet place with no distractions, have ink, paintbrush, and paper or a wooden tablet, and succeed in a Read/Write Sanskrit (in the case of a Buddhist monk) or Japanese Read/Write (in the case of a Shinto priest). The process takes one hour and requires spending 3 MP.

Effect of an ofuda

If placed at the entrance of a building, it will work like the incantation **Screen** against any evil spirit that wishes to enter, using the Willpower of the priest or monk who created the ofuda.

A more powerful version can also be created if the priest or monk knows the Spirit Block miracle. In that case, the monk casts the miracle at the moment of creating the ofuda, and it is impregnated in the talisman for one year. The intensity of the miracle will be equal to a tenth of the Exhort/Mysticism of the monk or equal to the intensity of the kami who cast the miracle (see rules of Shinto magic).

One other option is direct application. If the Buddhist priest encounters an evil spirit and passes a successful Fighting, he may touch the spirit's forehead with the ofuda, which causes the spirit 1d6 of spiritual damage per point of intensity of the Spirit Block or one-twentieth of his Mysticism or Exhortation skill, whichever is greater. After this use, the ofuda loses its properties.

Buddhist temples

Life of a Buddhist monk

Prayer and meditation

In the monasteries or large temples, a part of the day is reserved for meditation, about four hours, usually divided between times around sunrise and sunset. These sessions are done in groups, although individual monks may meditate alone at other times of the day. One of the masters leads the sessions. Sitting meditation alternates with walking meditation to relieve the legs. Prayers consist of chanting sutras in a group and are considered another form of meditation. Reading the Lotus Sutra aloud is said to be a blessing for all living beings.

Work

Japanese monasteries must be largely self-sufficient, and monks work some or all of the fields owned by the monastery. The larger schools have a lot of land, and some is worked by farmers. Another part of the day is devoted to maintenance work such as gardening,

cleaning, cooking, construction, tending to the sick, training in martial arts, etc. This work is done in alternance by the monks. On some occasions, monks participate in the construction of public works such as bridges and dams for the community around the monastery.

Meals

In Zen monasteries, there are usually only two meals, before noon.
In all Buddhist monasteries, meals are strictly vegetarian.

Alms

Despite being self-sufficient, most monasteries also ask for alms from neighbor inhabitants and nobles. This is both a symbolic and practical act. It is typically done through silent procession through one of the neighboring villages. The first monk makes a noise with his shakujo (a staff with metal rings on top). In the case of solitary monks or monks on a pilgrimage, they may hold a bowl in a street corner while ringing a bell.

It is considered beneficial for a monk to go on pilgrimage to various temples in the country, receiving teachings from various masters (even from different schools) before returning. It is tradition that one pilgrim monk is only allowed to sleep in a monastery if he first defeats a resident in a theological duel.

Shinto cults and magics

Shinto typical cult

Japan is the country of eighty myriads of kami. Everything worthy of reverence has a kami, whether it is the sun, a forest, or the ancestors. The Shinto faithfuls pray to these kamis either to honor them, appease their anger, or obtain their help or blessing.

There are several groups of kami:

- the **great kami of legends**, such as Amaterasu or Susanoo;
- the **kami of the natural elements**, such as the kami of a village, the kami of a valley, the kami of a forest, the kami of a crossroads, the kami of swords, the kami of a river, the kami of fertility, etc.;
- and the **kami of the deceased worthy of honor**, such as ancestors and important personalities.

Requirements

- Be Japanese of adult age
- Not be engaged in an impure profession such as gravedigger, tanner, butcher, or collector of animal manure.

Duties

- Respect all kami and their sacred places.
- To purify oneself before entering the sacred precincts of a shrine.

Skills and magical traditions

Dancing (kagura or local festival folk dance), Customs, Combat style (kannushi), Talking to kami (Binding), Influence, Music (gagaku), Seeing the invisible world (Trance).

Ranks and privileges

1. **Simple believer:** in exchange for an appropriate offering, at a shrine or at the annual feast of the appropriate kami, the believer can obtain an omamori.
2. **Local shrine keeper (shishō 祠掌):** believer who is responsible for maintaining a small shrine or sacred place and making periodic offerings to please the kami residing there. He usually has another separate profession.
 - a. Requirements: to be a person respected in their community, Customs 80%, Music (gagaku) 30%, Dancing 30%.
3. **Maid helper (miko 巫女):** Equivalent to spiritual devotee according to RQ6 rules.
 - a. Requirements: be a virgin between 13 and 25 years of age. Customs 70%, Music (gagaku) 30%, Dancing (kagura) 30%, Talking to kami 30%, Seeing the invisible world 30%.
 - b. Duties: to serve as assistants to the priests of a medium or large shrine. Let oneself be temporarily possessed by a kami so that he can transmit his messages. Make offerings of music and dance to satisfy the kami of the shrine.
4. **Priests (kannushi 神主):** can be male or female.
 - a. Requirements: Customs 70%, Dancing or Music 20%, Talking to kami 30%, Seeing the invisible world 30%.
 - b. Duties: take care of the shrines, officiate weddings and help the faithful receive blessings from the kami. Make offerings of music and dance to satisfy the kami of the shrine.
 - c. The following ranks are all shinto priests, a description of the hierarchy of kannushi existing in medium and large shrines:
- 4.1. **Gonnegi 権禰宜 (assistant priest to a negi):** Equivalent to spiritual devotee according to the rules of RQ6.
 - a. Requirements: Customs 50%, Dancing or Music 20%, Combat Style (kannushi) 30%, Talking to kami 30%, Seeing the invisible world 30%.
- 4.2. **Negi 禰宜 (low priests):** Equivalent to shaman according to RQ6 rules.
 - a. Requirements: Customs 65%, Dancing or Music 30%, Combat style (kannushi) 50%, Talking to the kami 50%, Influence 50%, See the invisible world 50%, Will 50%.
- 4.3. **Gongūji 権宮司 (assistant priest to a gūji):** Equivalent to shaman according to the rules of RQ6.
 - a. Requirements: Customs 80%, Music 30%, Dancing 30%, Combat style (kannushi) 60%, Influence 60%, Speak with kami 60%, See the invisible world 60%, Will 60%.
 - b. Acquires the gift **Create sacred arrows** (see p. 15).
- 4.4. **Gūji 宮司 (high priest of a shrine):** Equivalent to great shaman according to the rules of RQ6.

- a. Requirements: Customs 90%, Music 50%, Dancing 30%, Combat style(kannushi) 70%, Influence 70%, Speak with kami 70%, See the invisible world 70%
 - b. Acquires the gift **Oracle** (to use it he must spend 2 MP and pass a Talk to the kami).
- 4.5. **Daigūji 大宮司 (high priest of an imperial shrine):** high priest of the shrine of Ise or Atsuta. Equivalent to great shaman according to RQ6 rules.
- a. Requirements: Customs 100%, Music 50%, Dancing 50%, Combat style (kannushi) 90%, Influence 90%, Speak with kami 90%, See the invisible world 90%.
 - b. Acquires the gift **Perfection (POU)**.
- 4.6. **Saishu 祭主 (supreme priest or priestess of the imperial sanctuary of Ise):** he/she is responsible for special ceremonies in the imperial sanctuary of Ise, above the daigūji. Equivalent to grand shaman according to RQ6 rules.
- a. Requirements: to be a gūji appointed by the Jingikan, the deities department of the imperial government, or be a descendant of the imperial lineage. Customs 100%, Music 50%, Dancing 50%, Combat style(kannushi) 90%, Influence 90%, Talking to the kami 100%, Seeing the unseen world 100%.
 - b. They obtain the gift **Fortuna (blessed by Amaterasu Ōkami)**.

Shinto magic

The kamis are equivalent to the spirits described in the RQ6 and Mythras rules, with some changes. None of those described here can initiate spiritual combat.

There are three types of kami:

- the **kami of the natural elements** :
 - kami of levels 1 through 5 who can offer their powers in exchange for appropriate offerings. For example, the kami of a mountain or large forest can be of level 4, while the kami of a tree may be 1 to 2.
 - They are roughly equivalent to the nature spirits of Mythras and know common magic.
 - They are the most numerous type of kami and include not only animals and vegetation, but also fields, rivers, the night, the wind, or the sun, and even abstract forces such as fertility or joy.
- the **great kami of legends**, such as Amaterasu or Susanoo;
 - These are kami of natural elements, but so powerful that they also offer theistic miracles. For example, Sunspeaker in the case of Amaterasu.
 - Receiving their help requires great ceremonies and offerings at imperial shrines.
- and the **kami of the deceased worthy of honor**, such as ancestors and important personalities.
 - The kami of ancestors can be of levels 1 to 4. Great historical figures such as Minamoto Yorimitsu, founders of family lines or great masters are level 3, great masters are level 3 to 5. They are equivalent to ancestor spirits or guardian spirits of RuneQuest 6 or Mythras.
 - All kami can offer blessings (magic) to people who treat them with respect.

Miko and kannushi

They follow the animism rules of Mythras with some exceptions. The abilities of **Trance** and **Binding** are called respectively **See the invisible world** and **Speak with the kami**. They can neither project their soul to the spiritual plane nor travel through it.

Omamori

In exchange for making an offering at a shrine, any Shintoist can obtain an amulet (called an oinori or omamori) blessed by the kami who dwells at the shrine. This amulet contains the sacred name of the kami or a prayer written on a piece of paper and covered with cloth.

For game purposes, there are two types of omamori : common magic foci and fetishes.

Omamori "focus" only works for a specific person. This person, when they are in contact with it and pass a Common Magic roll, can cast one of the Common Magic spells known to the kami of the shrine kami and only that one.

For example: Bladesharp in the case of the kami of swords, or Reclamation (fish) in the case of the kami of the sea. In addition, in all the sanctuaries the spell Cleanse (p. 186 of RQ6) can be learned without the need for omamori.

On the other hand, **"fetish" omamori** function like the fetishes described in RuneQuest 6, although the kannushi do not bind the kami in them, but rather the friendly kami imbue them with part of their essence so that the priest or follower can later ask them for help.

To use them, it is necessary to have the skill Speak with the kami (Binding). The purity rules described on page 13 apply to anyone who has this skill. A certain level of skill is required to ask for help, depending on the kami residing in him (see table on page 10).

Otherwise, the follower or kannushi can "unleash" the kami. If friendly, the kami will help the owner of the omamori according to the table on page 205 of RuneQuest 6, but this amulet can no longer be used again. The kami of the ancestors are always friendly to their descendants if they maintain a domestic altar and make small daily offerings to them. However, the legendary kami and kami of the natural elements are neutral. To establish a friendly relationship with a kami, one must first erect a shrine in his honor, take care of it and make daily offerings to the kami.

Note: the kami of a volcano (such as Mt. Fuji) can cause eruptions that can affect a kannushi even if he has a friendly relationship with him because that is his nature. Even so, all kami capable of causing disasters offer the Healing abilities.

Kami level	Type of sacred site and construction cost in koku (石).
0-1	Beautiful natural place, purified and periodically cleaned (2 石)
2	Small sanctuary (190 石)
3-4	Medium sanctuary (600 石, income: 1D6x25 石/year, maintenance.: 75 石/year)
5+	Large sanctuary (1440 石, income: 3D6x25 石/year, maintenance.: 250 石/year)

If a shrine is built below the minimum size required by the kami, it can only offer common magic in the form of omamori “focus”. For example, a small shrine of Inari (level 4 kami) can only offer the common magic and not amulets with the “kami servant” described below.

A kannushi also blesses buildings and fields to ward off evil spirits and prevent misfortune. Any house or building that is built must first have the blessing of the local kami applied through a kannushi or shrine attendant. When blessing a building, the kannushi building, the kannushi grants it a **Resist Disaster** skill equal to one-third of its current *Speak with the kami* skill. When a disaster such as an earthquake or a fire threatens the building, the game director assigns the disaster a percentage of intensity. For example, 80% to a strong earthquake. The intensity of the disaster and the building's Resist are rolled against each other in an opposed roll. If the building wins, the effect of the disaster is superficial. In addition, in all large shrines there is a “kami servant” of level 4 with the miracle Fortify which, instead of adding PA to the building, adds +5% to the building's Disaster Resistance skill for each level of the miracle's intensity. The miracle **Bless Crops** can still be used to avoid disasters in crop fields.

A peculiarity of the kami is that they can be in many places at once. To represent this ubiquity, when you invoke the help of a kami, you actually invoke part of its essence, which in these rules is called “servant kami”. This is only for game purposes : a follower of the kami will never say “Amaterasu has sent me a kami servant to help me”, but directly : “Amaterasu has granted me his grace”.

Some powerful kami can offer blessings in the form of theistic miracles. In game terms, this is represented by “servant kami” of intensity from 4 to 7 who know theistic miracles with an Exhortation percentage of 100%. The intensity and magnitude of the miracle is one-twentieth of the ability *Speak with the kami* of the requesting kannushi, but with a maximum equal to the intensity of the kami.

For example: a kannushi with *Speak with kami* 81% requests the favor of Raijin (POU 26, level 4) to cast a Lightning miracle against a Chinese pirate. With Raijin's omamori in hand, he passes the *Speak with the kami* roll and Raijin casts a Lightning Bolt of intensity 4 from the skies that deals 2D6 damage. A kami can also be asked to cast one of the common magic spells he knows. His Common Magic skill is 60+(10 x level). For example, 80% for a level 2 kami.

When a kami grants an increase to a skill, it does not increase by one degree for every two levels of intensity, but increases by 10% per level of the kami.

For example, a level 3 kami with the power to increase Endurance will bless his follower with a +30% modifier to his Endurance skill.

However, as mentioned on p. 142 of *Mythras*, the augmentation cannot increase the ability, characteristic, attribute beyond twice its original value.

Finally, all kami of level 3 and above can bestow general blessings on their faithful through the priests. This is represented by “servant kami” capable of covertly possessing a believer and granting 1 extra point of luck for every two levels of the kami.

List of Kami

A kami's powers and fields of influence are often not exclusive. There may be more than one kami offering the same powers, and which one a believer will go to depends primarily on the traditions of his or her place of origin and the proximity of the shrine.

Several examples of kamis are described below. The percentage of Speak with the kami needed to use an omamori containing a "servant kami" is specified next to the kami's level and in an table below, so as not to have to consult the spiritual intensity table on page 196 of the RuneQuest 6 rulebook every time.

It should be mentioned that the powers and blessings offered by the kami in this short list do not cover everything a kami can do for his faithful. The imagination of the players and the game director, bound by the area of influence of each kami and their legends, should always be above and beyond a simple list of spells, blessings, and miracles. To know the kami better and to be able to improvise in this sense, it is recommended that the game director read books on this subject. Several suggestions are offered at the end of this document.

XXX_To be completed_XXX Great kamis of legends

Amaterasu Ōmikami

kami of the heavens, the sun, and the emperors.

Level 7 (151%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 4-7): .

Servant Kami (level 7): .

Susanoo-no-mikoto

kami of the destructive force of the storms and seas, king of the underworld. Brother of Amaterasu.

Level 6 (131%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 4-6): .

Servant Kami (level 6): .

Tsukuyomi-no-mikoto

kami of the moon and the night. Brother of Amaterasu.

Level 6 (131%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 4-6): .

Servant Kami (level 6): .

Ōkuninushi-no-kami

Great Lord of the Earth, kami of marriages and medicine. King of the invisible world of spirits and magic.

Level 5 (121%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 4-5): .

Servant Kami (level 5): .

Sarutahiko Ōkami

kami of crossroads and paths. Leader of the earthly kami. Husband of Ama-no-uzume.

Level 5 (121%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 4-5): .

Servant Kami (level 5): .

Ama-no-Uzume-no-mikoto

kami of dawn, festivity, joy and dance. Wife of Sarutahiko.

Level 5 (121%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 4-5): .

Servant Kami (level 5): .

Hachiman

kami of battles and agriculture. Patron of warriors.

Level 5 (121%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 3-5): .

Servant Kami (level 5): .

Ryūjin/Watatsumi

sea dragon king, kami of the ocean and the depths.

Level 5 (121%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 3-5): .

Servant Kami (level 5): .

XXX_To be completed_XXX Major Kami

Inari

kami of rice, blacksmiths and trade.

Level 5 (121%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 2-5): .

Servant Kami (level 5): .

Tachikarao no kami

kami of physical strength

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 2-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Konohanasakuya hime

Princess of the cherry blossoms, kami of the cherry trees, of the lightness of life, of the of life, of safe childbirth and of appeasing the wrath of volcanoes, like Mount Fuji.

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 2-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Yagokoro Omoikane no kami

kami of wisdom. Advisor of Amaterasu.

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 2-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Takemikazuchi no mikoto

kami of swords, was born from the blood at the base of Izanagi's sword when cutting the fire kami.

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 2-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Shinatsuhiko no kami

kami of the wind.

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 1-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Raijin

kami of thunder and lightning.

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 3-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Suijin

kami of all sources of water: irrigation canals, wells, ponds, lakes, streams, or springs.

Level 4 (91%).

Common magic:.

Servant Kami (level 3-4): .

Servant Kami (level 4): .

Minor Kamis

These are the kami of the most numerous and common natural elements. Their power can vary widely.

Here are some examples that can be used as references :

Sukarō-no-kami: Protective kami of the Sukarō mountain valley.

Level 3 (71%).

Common magic: Heal.

Servant Kami (level 2-3): Bless Knowledge (Agriculture), Bless Region (Sukarō).

Asogawa-no-kami: kami of the Aso River.

Level 3 (71%).

Common magic: Chill, Find (fish).

Servant Kami servers (level 3): Demesne Aso river (increase or decrease the water flow).

Numazujō-no-nezumi-no-kami: kami of the mice of Numazu Castle.

Level 2 (51%).

Common magic: Pet (mice).

Kami servers (level 1-2): bless Stealth

Kami of the deceased worthy of honor

Unlike the spirits of the ancestors (p. 387 of RuneQuest 6), the kami of the ancestors only possess the people to speak through them. Still, for game purposes they work like the spirits of the ancestors. Optionally, these kamis can act as guardian spirits (p. 396 of RuneQuest 6).

Below, you can see a couple of examples:

Kuroki-Kento-no-kami: kami of the ancestors of the Kuroki samurai clan

Level 2 (51%).

- Common magic: Mindspeech.

- Acts as a guardian spirit (p. 396 of RuneQuest 6), INT 14, POW 15, CHA 14.

Spectral Combat: 79%, Willpower 80%.

Takeda-no-kami: kami of the ancestors of the great Takeda samurai clan.

Level 2 (51%).

INT 15, POW 16, CHA 12. Will: 82%.

Skills: Knowledge (Strategy and Tactics) 131%, Oratory 131%.

Common Magic 70%: Bladesharp, Pierce.

Kami ally (level 1): bless Region (Kai province).

Kami without a shrine

As explained in the rules of RuneQuest 6 and Mythras, it is possible to contact a kami and negotiate with them outside the precincts of a shrine or sanctified place. In fact, the vast majority of Japan's millions of kami do not reside in any shrine dedicated to them, but in natural spaces. In that case, the kami is no longer friendly, but neutral. To find a kami in a natural area, two conditions must be met: an appropriate place and a minimum of skill.

Appropriate place

To speak with a kami, one must go to the natural space that forms his or her sphere of influence. For example, to speak with the kami of a crossroads, one must be at that crossroads, and to speak with the kami of a tree, one must be next to that tree. In the case of large areas of influence, such as a forest, a river, a valley, or a mountain, simply entering the area does not guarantee finding the kami, but rather one must find the most spectacular place in that area, which is often far from civilization. To do so, it is necessary to pass a Region roll or ask the locals. For example, to contact the kami of Mt. Fuji it is necessary to ascend to the edge of the crater of Mount Fuji.

In the case of kami of abstract forces, such as fertility or joy, it is necessary to find a situation where that force abounds to the maximum. For example, a harvest in the case of a fertility kami of fertility or a feast with much merriment in the case of a kami of joy.

In the case of legendary celestial kami (Amaterasu, Tsukuyomi, Susanoo, Ama-no-uzume), one must ascend a mountain and contact them at the appropriate time. For example, to contact Tsukuyomi or Amaterasu, the sky must be totally clear of clouds and the moon or the sun must be visible. In the case of Amaterasu, it should be just at noon or dawn of the summer solstice. In the case of Tsukuyomi, there must be a full moon. In the case of Susanoo, there must be a storm with hurricane force winds. In the case of earthly legendary kami, such as Ōkuninushi or Sarutahito, one must also be in a mountain and in a place befitting their legend. For example, in Izumo in the case of Ōkuninushi.

Minimum skill level

To talk to a kami in a natural area, it is not enough to have the minimum 20% of Talking to kami mentioned on the previous page, but at least 10 percentile points less than the minimum percentage needed to the minimum percentage necessary to be able to control a kami in an omamori (see the table on page 10), but without going below 20%. For example: 61% for a level 3 kami.

In the case of legendary kami, it is also necessary to convince them by means of a long ritual which in game terms is represented by a spiritual combat. This can involve Several people with the skill Speak with the kami. When generating the kami's request by means of the table on page 11, add 20 to the result of the roll. That is, the kami in question is more likely to request a shrine.

Purity

Penalty to “See the invisible world” and “Speak with the kami”

Purity is critical in the Shinto religion. Becoming contaminated in various ways harms the relationships between human beings and kami, who are pure beings. Kamis shun impure people, so to deal with them, it is essential to be perfectly clean and purified. To reflect this, the See the Invisible World (Trance) and Talk to the Kami (Binding) skills are reduced as the person becomes contaminated by committing impure acts and transgressing the taboos of religion (see table below). The penalty coming from different actions can cumulate, but each type of action can only lead to one penalty.

The kami in sacred places will flee from anyone who does not have a minimum of effective 20% in ***Talking with the kami***. They will flee whether this contaminated person tries to communicate with them or comes within 8 meters of theirshintai (sacred object in the inner sanctuary -honden- where resides the essence of the kami, often a mirror).

Taboo	Penalty
Getting dirty	-20%
Being in a dirty place	
Eating meat or fish	
Deliberately lying	
Damaging a field or crops	

Attending a funeral or entering a cemetery	
Attending a birth	
Inflict a wound ^(a)	
Cause death ^(a)	-30%
Touching or getting stained with someone else's blood	
Being infected by a disease	
Touching or spending more than 5 minutes next to a yomi ^(b)	
Desecrate a temple or allow it to be desecrated	-40%
Offending a Kami (or fumble a "Talking to the Kami" roll)	
Breaking a promise done to a Kami ^(c)	-100%

(a) Except for evil yōkai and underworld beings such as oni, bakemono, yurei or shikome, among others. But including to himself.

(b) Yomi are being from the underworld such as Oni, bakemono, yurei, shikome or others

(c) In this case, the only way to remove the penalty is to fulfill the promise

If at any time one of the two abilities reaches 0% or less due to a violation or accumulated contamination, the player must immediately make a Willpower test.

- If he doesn't pass it, your character will abandon what he was doing at that moment to go as soon as possible to a sanctuary or sacred place and begin the purification ritual (misogi).
- If he passes the roll, he can endure the crisis of consciousness for a time, but he will try to go to a shrine to purify himself whenever he has the chance.

If there is no sanctuary nearby, he will go to the nearest river or waterfall to purify himself.

Purification

To purify themselves for transgressions committed, anyone with the Speak to Kami skill must perform a purification ritual.

To achieve this, she must go to a shrine to perform the misogi ritual and purify herself. With each day dedicated to it, you will decrease the penalty by 5% in a large shrine, 3% in a medium shrine and 1% in a small shrine.

If the skill has dropped below the basic percentage of the skill (the sum of the characteristics), before going to a shrine, you should spend a day washing your body in clean water. This clean water can be the clean water of a waterfall, or a river with water that

is neither too fast nor too slow, as Izanagi did when fleeing from the yomi. That will restore her abilities to the basic level.

Until they regain the minimum required percentage in both skills, the kannushi or miko will not be able to perform the duties of their profession.

Recovery of magic points

To recover the magic points used to cast common magic, talents or miracles, a priest from a Pure Land or Tendai school must pray in his temple, while a priest of the Nara, Shingon or Zen schools must meditate.

While meditating to recover magic points, the Meditation skill does not provide any other advantage.

Action		Magic point recovered
Praying in a quiet place		1 per hour up to $\frac{1}{4}$ of the max
Praying in a small shrine		1 per hour up to $\frac{1}{2}$ of the max
Praying in a medium shrine		1 per hour up to $\frac{3}{4}$ of the max
Praying in a large shrine		1 per hour up to the max
Praying in an imperial shrine		1 per $\frac{1}{2}$ hour up to the max
Actively participate in a sacred Shinto festival		All
Making an offering at a shrine :	More than 1 b	1PM (max once per day)
	More than 1 m	3PM (max once per week)
	more than 5 m	6PM (max once per month)
Building a Torii or a shrine		All

Sacred arrows

As described on p. 2, priests acquire the gift of creating sacred arrows when they are invested as gongūji. These sacred arrows or hamaya (破魔矢) contain the blessing of the kami of the shrine where they are created and have a level associated with that kami's level or lower. For example, a hamaya consecrated at a normal Raijin shrine will be level 4 or lower.

When fired by a person with Speak with the kami of 20% or higher, the hamaya paralyze any evil being that they directly touch and whose POW is lower than the arrow's level multiplied by five. For example, an arrow of level 3 will be able to paralyze a demon (oni) of POW 15 or

less. In addition, once launched, all the infernal beings, whether demons or spirits, located within a radius of levelx3 in meters of the arrow, will suffer a number of points of damage in a random location equal to half the level of the arrow, each round. The radius of effect of the arrow remains active until the arrow is broken.

These arrows are usually shot at the four cardinal points of a sanctuary to protect it from underworld beings and evil spirits. They are also sometimes used to purify a new house or building by planting an arrow in one corner and another in the opposite corner.

At the end of a year, the sacred arrows lose all their powers and must be consecrated again. Creating one of these arrows reduces the magic points of the priest who creates it by a number equal to the level of the arrow, until it breaks or loses its powers. Therefore, they are not frequently given to people outside the sanctuary without a good reason.

Laws in medieval Japan : The Goseibai Shikimoku

The Goseibai Shikimoku (御成敗式目) or the Formulary of Adjudications was the legal code of the Kamakura shogunate in Japan, promulgated by third shikken Hōjō Yasutoki on 27 August 1232.

Before enacting the Goseibai Shikimoku, the Kamakura shogunate conducted trials without formal laws. After the Jōkyū War, an increasing number of land disputes between its vassals, aristocrats and peasants made fair trials indispensable. There after Hōjō Yasutoki compiled the outline with 51 article headings and 13 Hyojoshu (councilors) completed it.

Supplementary articles to the Goseibai Shikimoku, called Tsuika (追加), were issued afterward. The Muromachi shogunate also adopted the Goseibai Shikimoku as the basic law. The Goseibai Shikimoku was largely repealed during the Edo period, though parts of it stayed in used until 1868, but was widely used as a textbook for writing in temple schools.

General information about the goseibai shikimoku is from various sources, the detail of the individual articles is coming mainly from :

<https://www.tamagawa.ac.jp/sisetu/kyouken/kamakura/goseibaishikimoku/>

The code was historically written with simple wording and vocabulary to make sure every one could understand it. Versions written without Chinese characters (kanji), only using syllabic kanas were also published to help its diffusion. Most inhabitants of medieval Japan were not very familiar with its content, but verdicts by courts and administration would often cite the article on which the decision was based.

This code is put here as a support for games where justice and investigation play a big role.

Article 1: Repair the shrine and cherish the festival

Respecting God renews your spiritual experience^(a). It is very important to repair shrines and make festivals more popular. This is because doing so will make people happy. Also, we must not stop making offerings and do not neglect traditional festivals and customs. Managers of Kantogobunkoku^(b), of Kokugaryo^(c) and of shoen^(d) manors must understand this well. When repairing a shrine, shrines with territory should carry out small repairs themselves, and report large repairs that cannot be handled to the shogunate. After researching the content, choose the best method.

- a) Reigen = Mysterious signs that appear when praying to the gods and Buddha, "Goriyaku"
- b) Kantogobunkoku = Shogun's Chigyo-koku = lands controlled by the shogun
- c) Kokugaryo = territory that pays taxes to the imperial court, but in the case of the Kanto region, taxes are also paid to the shogun
- d) Shoen = territory of powerful aristocrats and large temples and shrines, but in the Kamakura period (Many of them were nomina

Article 2: Repair temples and pagodas and perform duties as a monk

Monks must manage temples and pagodas properly and be diligent in their daily duties. Temples and shrines are things that people should respect, and we must not neglect the repair and service of these buildings so as not to cause them to be criticized later. Also, monks who use temple property without permission or who do not fulfill their duties should be immediately expelled from the temple.

Article 3: About the work of the shugo

Since Lord Yoritomo was appointed, the shugo's duties have been to exhort retainers for service^(a), control rebels, and murderers. Furthermore, there are crackdowns on night raids, robberies, bandits, and pirates. Shugos can send magistrates to villages to demand statute labor from the villagers as they wish and collect taxes. There are also people who rule over local areas even though they are not daikan^(b), and who collect taxes even though they are not jito. All of these actions are illegal and are prohibited. Also, even if a person has been a vassal for generations, a person who does not own a fief cannot assume a position of management without permission. There are some shokan who pretend to be vassals and do not follow the orders of the shokan^(c) or ryoke^(d). Such people should not be entrusted with various responsibilities, even if they wish to do so. As when Lord Yoritomo decided, the shugo's job was to decide who would be in charge of yaku^(e) service, investigate rebels and murders, and arrest criminals, and he was not allowed to do anything else. As soon as a shugo who violates this agreement is sued by the provincial governor or feudal lord, or his illegality is revealed to the land chiefs or common people, he is forced to resign, and an appropriate person is appointed as shugo. Also, only one person may be appointed as the guardian.

- a) Daiban dansuke = ordering a retainer to protect the imperial court
- b) daikan = here an official acting on behalf of the shugo

- c) Shokan: The role of managing a manor under the orders of the lord or head family, but the not actual owner.
- d) Ryoke: The nominal owner of the manor. Above that is the "head family." Both are nominal owners.
- e) Yaku = Police work, land organizer, etc

Article 4: Prohibition of the Shugo from arbitrarily confiscating territory from criminals

Serious crimes must be carefully investigated, the results must be reported to the shogunate, and the shogunate's instructions must be followed. It is not permissible for guardians to neglect this and take possession of property confiscated from criminals without permission, and those who do not comply will be dismissed . Furthermore, even if a person is a felon, the mansion and furniture of his wife and children shall not be confiscated. In the case of an accomplice, if there is no property to be confiscated, there will be no question regarding property.

Article 5: Regarding the disposition of landowners who do not pay the collected annual tax to the honjo^(a)

Landlords who do not pay the annual tax to the Honjo must immediately comply with the Honjo's requests and make up for any shortages immediately. If there is a large amount that cannot be paid back, it should be paid in full to the main office within three years. If someone do not comply with this, he will be dismissed.

- a) Honjo = owner of the manor (often nominal)

Article 6: The shogunate shall not intervene in the trials of provincial governors and feudal lords

The shogunate does not intervene in lawsuits initiated by the Kokuga^(a), the head office of a manor, or a shrine or temple. Without a letter of recommendation from the head office , the shogunate would not be able to take up any complaints from manors or temples or shrines.

- a) Kokuga = territory controlled by the imperial court
- b) This article indicates that the Goseibaishikimoku was created for the vassals of the shogunate.

Article 7: Regarding the handling of territories given by Lord Yoritomo and Masako^(a)

Lands granted to gokenin during the time of Lord Yoritomo cannot be deprived of their rights even if the Honjo and other parties appeal. Shoryo is something that is given to a retainer based on military merit or service as an official , and there is a proper reason for it. Nevertheless, it is extremely dissatisfying for the lords of the lords to refer to the territory assigned to them as "the land of their ancestors." Therefore, such lawsuits will not be taken up. However, if the retainer commits a crime, the feudal lord is allowed to sue. However, it is

prohibited to file a lawsuit again after a judgment has been issued. It is not permissible to ignore previous judgments, and in such cases the unfaithfulness will be recorded on paper.

a) Masako = Masako Hojo

Article 8: When you have a letter of authority (mikudashibumi), but you do not actually control the land.

As Prince Yoritomo had arranged, land that was ruled by a retainer for 20 years does not need to be returned to the original lord (aristocrats, temples and shrines, etc.). However, the arrangement does not apply to those who falsely claim to have ruled the land when in fact they did not, even if they have a certificate^(a).

a) Gochamon = a certificate issued by the shogun guaranteeing the territory

Article 9: Dealing with those who commit rebellion^(a)

Since it is difficult to determine the punishment for rebellion in detail, a detailed investigation shall be made and a trial shall be held with reference to past cases.

a) Rebellion = to fight a war against the emperor or shogun.

Article 10: Criminal charges such as murder and stabbing

If a person kills another person, even in an argument or in a drunken quarrel, he is guilty of murder, and the offender shall be sentenced to death or exile and his property shall be confiscated. However, if the father and son of the person who committed the crime are unrelated, they are not guilty, and the same is true for the crime of inflicting injury.

However, if a person kills someone claiming to be the enemy of a child, grandchild, or ancestor, the murderer's father or grandfather is guilty of the same crime even if he or she does not know about it. This is because, as a result, they end up accomplishing their destiny in order to appease their ancestors' anger

Furthermore, if a child commits murder in order to usurp his status or property, the father will be found not guilty if he is unrelated.

a) Individual crimes are punished against the individual, but when it comes to enemies, needless conflict is suppressed by punishing the same people. I can see that they are trying to do so. This is because it was quite common in those days that even if a war divided the enemy into two sides, they would be forgiven after the war and treated equally as the shogun's retainers.

Article 11: Determining whether the wife's property will be confiscated due to the husband's crime

In cases of serious crimes such as rebellion, murder, banditry, pirates, night raids, and robbery, the wife's territory would be confiscated if the husband was guilty. However, if the husband accidentally injures or kills the other person during an argument, the wife's territory will not be confiscated .

Article 12: About the crime of evil speech^(a)

Evil speech, which is a source of strife, is forbidden. Any serious abuse shall result in exile, and even minor abuse shall result in jail time. Anyone who speaks ill of the other party during a trial shall immediately lose the trial. If a person sues without cause, his lands shall be confiscated, and if he has no lands, he shall be exiled.

a) evil speech = to speak ill of a person.

Article 13: Concerning the Crime of Committing Violence Against Another Person

If a feudal lord commits violence against another, he shall forfeit his fief. If there is no territory, the offender shall be exiled. If the person is not a noble, he or she shall be put in jail.

Article 14: Concerning the Determination of Whether the Crime of a Deputy Is to be imputed on His Master

If a deputy commits a crime, the master who appointed him shall report it to the Shogunate, and the master shall be acquitted. However, if the master neglects to report the matter to the shogunate, the master's fief shall be confiscated and the deputy shall be placed in prison. The master shall be equally guilty if the deputy usurps the tribute or breaks precedent or the law. If a person fails to respond to a summons from the shogunate government office when a suit is brought by a deputy or the head office, the master's fief shall be forfeited. However, there are lighter or lighter penalties depending on the severity of the crime committed.

Article 15: On the Crime of Forging Documents

A person who makes a false document shall forfeit his territory. Those who do not have a fief shall be exiled. In the case of commoners, their faces shall be branded. Those who make forged documents at the request of others shall be guilty of the same offense. Those who lied during the trial should be ordered to repair shrines and temples, and those who failed to do so should be banished.

Article 16: Regarding the territory confiscated during the Jokyu rebellion (Jokyu no ran)

Among the feudal lords whose territories were confiscated after the Jokyu War, those who were later proven not to be rebels had their territories returned to them. The new lord who was already in the territory to be returned will be given a replacement territory. This is because they were people who worked hard during the battle and achieved great results.

The crime of a person who rebelled against the shogunate even though he was a retainer of the shogunate was a serious crime, and he was sentenced to death and his property was confiscated. However, from now on, those found to have been on the side of the Imperial Court will be specially forgiven and only one-fifth of their property will be confiscated. In the case of those who are not members of the imperial household, but are subordinates or administrators of a manor, their property shall not be confiscated in the future.

In addition, there are many complaints such as claiming that the lord whose property was confiscated is the illegal lord while pretending to be the original lord, and requesting that the illegal lord return the confiscated land. This is completely unreasonable, so such request will not be heard.

Article 17: Dispositions when Father and Son Participate in the Same Battle from Different Positions

In the case of samurai from the eastern regions, when a father and son fought separately on the side of the imperial court and the shogunate, the person who fought on the side of the shogunate shall be given a reward, whether it was the father or the son. On the other hand, the person who was on the side of the imperial court, whether it was the father or the son, should be punished.

Furthermore, in the case of samurai from the western regions, if either the father or son was on the side of the imperial court, both father and son would be punished as if they had mutually agreed. However, in cases where the father and son were far apart and could not contact each other, only those who sided with the imperial court would be punished.

Article 18: Concerning the case of forcing a woman to return a possession (hankan) after she has inherited it.

Even though there are differences between men and women, the blessings of parents are the same. Until now, girls (daughters) have not been obliged to make restitution, but from now on, the parents may take back their estates even after their daughter have inherited them. This was done to prevent girls from hesitating to inherit for fear of later disputes, or to prevent them from committing immoral acts against their parents. By guaranteeing this, the female inheritor will show filial piety to her parents, and the parents will raise her with peace of mind and give her land.

- a) Until now, under the Noble Law (law for aristocrats), there was no repentance for women, but under the Samurai Law, men and women were treated equally. (See Article 26)

Article 19: In the case of a retainer who has been given property under the guise of fidelity, but changes his attitude after the death of his master.

If a retainer who has been given property or a letter of assignment because he has respected his master and worked well, and after the master's death he forgets his favor and fights with the master's children to take the property; the property shall be taken away from him and given entirely to the master's children.

Article 20: In the event of the death of a child to whom a letter of inheritance has been given

Inheritance rights may change even if the child to whom the property was given is still alive, so if the child dies, the retainer is free to choose the next heir.

Article 21: Regarding the Treatment of Land Inherited by a Wife or Concubine (Mekake) after Separation.

In the case of a great fault on the part of a divorced wife or concubine. Even if there is a contract, it is not possible for a woman to possess territory inherited from her ex-husband. Even if the ex-husband only cares about his new wife and concubine, and he cannot take back the land he gave to his ex-wife or concubine if she did not commit a great fault.

Article 22: Concerning the property to be given to the children (eldest son) of a divorced first wife.

A person who is a legitimate child (who has grown up) who has worked well for the family but has been removed from the family by the second wife if his/her father or her children, shall be given one-fifth of his/her share of the legitimate inheritance at the time of inheritance. However, if some property was distributed to the child before the divorce, that amount may be deducted. However, if the child is lazy or unhappy, this is not necessary.

Article 23: Adoption of a Female Child

It has been allowed since the time of Lord Yoritomo to adopt a child to inherit the territory after the husband dies. If the couple has no children, and there is no problem with that.

Article 24: Concerning the Estate of the Successor Family after Remarriage.

After the husband's death, the wife must mourn for him and do the ceremonies as stipulated in the Shikimoku.

Furthermore, it is not good practice for a wife to remarry immediately after bereavement. When a widow remarries, she must give the land inherited from her deceased husband to his children. If there are no children, another method is to be devised to deal with the situation.

Article 25: A courtier who becomes a son-in-law of a feudal retainer shall perform his duties as a samurai.

Even though he is a court noble (buke), he performs the duties of a retainer. Even if the father is allowed to act in his place while he is alive, after the father's death, that person must work as a retainer. If he still fails to do so by taking advantage of his family's authority as a court noble, he will be forced to decline to inherit the territory . Furthermore, a daughter of a samurai family is not allowed to follow the customs of a court noble, and such a person cannot govern the territory.

Article 26: Given already inherited land to another child a

Even if a retainer gives a territory to one of his child as inheritance and receives a certificate from the shogun, the inheritance can be transferred to another child if the parents wish so.

Article 27: "Distribution of undisposed property"

In the event of the death of a family member before deciding on his inheritance, the property left to him shall be distributed to his wife and children according to his work and ability.

Article 28: "Do not make false accusations"

The sin of deceitful words is very serious. A person who makes a false accusation in the hope of obtaining a territory shall forfeit all his territories. If he has no territory, he shall be exiled. A person who lies in order to obtain an office is not allowed to hold that office.

Article 29: On the prohibition of asking another judge in lieu of the original judge.

If it is discovered that the judge naturally in charge of the case is being replaced by another judge in order to advance the trial in an advantageous manner, the trial will be adjourned while the investigation is conducted. This is because such a thing should not happen. Persons in charge shall not make such double intercessions. Additionally, if the trial is prolonged and takes more than 20 days, complaints can be made at the court of the shogunate.

Article 30: Prohibition against submitting a letter from an influential person to advance the trial without waiting for the ruling of the Inquiry Office.

An unfair trial, in which those who know the leading parties gain advantage and those who do not, lose disadvantage, is prohibited because the Inquiry Office itself loses credibility. Each side's arguments must be presented during the trial.

Article 31: Prohibition of Losing parties from Appealing Judgments and Prevention of Wrongful Rulings.

If a person loses a trial and then appeals to the judge, alleging that the judge's decision was "biased," and bringing up untruths, he shall forfeit one-third of his lands. If there is no such territory, he shall be banished. However, the judge who has actually made a biased ruling shall be forced to resign and shall not be appointed as a judge again.

Article 32: Prohibition of harboring thieves and miscreants within the territory

The local jito shall arrest bandits as soon as he finds them in his territory. If a jito harbors a bandit, he shall be guilty of the same offense. If there is any suspicion, an investigation will be conducted by the shogunate, and the Jito will be prohibited from returning to the district during that period. Also, if it is discovered that there are bandits in a place where the officials of the shogunate cannot enter (places outside the control of the Jito), the manager of those places must send their servants to arrest them immediately. Landlords who do not do this will be stopped and someone will be appointed to take their place.

Article 33: Regarding the punishment of robbers and arsonists

The crime of burglary shall be condemned to beheading, as has been the rule up to now. Arsonists shall be treated the same as burglars, and these crimes shall be eliminated.

- a) Actually, depending on the gravity of the crime, there were cases of banishment and imprisonment.

Article 34: Prohibition of illicit intercourse with married women.

A retainer who had an affair with a married woman would have half of his territory confiscated. If he has no territory, he shall be banished to a distant land. The wife of the other party shall also have half of her territory confiscated, and if she has no territory, she shall be exiled. In addition, it is forbidden to kidnap women on the road. If this is done, the retainer will be suspended from their posts for 100 days, and ordinary samurai below the rank of retainer will have to shave one side of their hair, following the precedent set by Lord Yoritomo. In the case of monks, punishments are decided according to the circumstances at the time.

Article 35: Treatment of Cases of Failure to Respond to Court Calls

A defendant who ignores the summons three times shall be tried by the plaintiff (gengoku)^(a) alone. If the plaintiff loses, the disputed property or territory shall be divided among the other retainers. After the oxen, horses, servants, etc. are counted, they must make a donation for the repair of shrines and temples.

a) Plaintiff = person filing a lawsuit. The person who is sued is the defendant (hikoku)
(This article was created to prevent unfair lawsuits over territory.)

Article 36: Regarding bringing up previous borders in court

bringing up the boundary lines that are favorable to them. This is because they think that their current territory will not be reduced even if they lose the lawsuit. From now on, when such a suit is filed, an investigator will be dispatched to the site to conduct a rigorous investigation, and if the suit is unjust, the sued party will be given an area of land the same size as the territory that was tried to be taken away from him.

Article 37: Prohibition of stealing the territory of the Imperial Court

Although it was prohibited during the reign of Prince Yoritomo, there are still people who invade the manors of retired emperors, cloistered emperors, or their wives. Any householder who continues to do so shall forfeit a part of his domain.

Article 38: Prohibition of Sojitô from seizing the territory of other retainer within their sphere of influence

A sojitô may not take even the land of a meishu who holds a certificate of fief, saying, "Since this is the territory given to me by the Shogun, all of it is within my sphere of influence (seiryoku han'i). Nevertheless, if someone tries to take the land of a meishu, another certificate is issued to the meishu. However, if the retainer refuses to give up the taxes he has collected to the head of the land, he may be replaced.

a) Sojitô = A landowner who owns a relatively large territory such as a village, township, or sho. There are various theories, but the Sojitô did not directly live there and rule the territory, but rather was a paper land leader who had the right to collect taxes (the right to collect taxes) in the area. Therefore, some of them even took over the land of the landowners (Nyasu) who had cultivated and become independent, such as the famous rice fields scattered within the manors. It seems that this provision was added for this purpose. It seems that this kind of thing happened often in the western countries, especially in the Kyushu region.

Article 39: Procedures for those wishing to receive official ranks^(a) and offices.

Those who work diligently and whose merits are recognized can receive official ranks from the Imperial Court through the recommendation of the shogunate after fair examination. However, it is not allowed to apply directly to the Imperial Court in the hope of being promoted. It is strictly prohibited for anyone to do so.

However, Shikoku^(b) and Kebiishi^(c) positions may be given without recommendation from the bakufu. Additionally, there will be no restrictions on those who receive official ranks based on seniority, as has been the case up until now.

- a) Official rank = a rank issued by the Imperial Court
- b) Shikoku = the head of the country appointed by the Imperial Court and assigned to the country. This person mainly held the position of kami (kami), but in the shogunate, the position is mostly a formal position.
- c) Kenbiishi = Imperial court official, mainly the job of the police within the court

Article 40: Prohibition of Priests Residing in the capital from Desiring Government Positions.

It is against the order of the temple and the teachings of Buddha for a young or low-ranking priest to receive an official rank without permission and to eclipse an elder or a high priest. Monks who have been given official ranks without permission are to be stopped. This also applies to monks affiliated with the shogunate.

Article 41: Regarding slaves and miscellaneous people

As was stipulated at the time of Prince Yoritomo, servants^(a) and miscellaneous persons^(b) who have not been employed for ten years or more shall be free. As for the children of servants, in the case of boys, they shall belong to their fathers, and in the case of girls, to their mothers.

- a) Nuhi = A person who is bought and sold like a slave.
- b) Zounin = low-status people known as servants or servants.

(At the ceremony, new human trafficking was prohibited, and current slaves who had not been used for more than 10 years would not be bought or sold in the future, and children of slaves would no longer be sold as slaves.)

Article 42: Regarding the property of runaway peasants

When a peasant runs away from his territory, his wife and children shall not be seized and robbed of their family property. If there is unpaid annual tax, only the shortfall must be paid. And, if there are any remaining family members, let them decide where they want to live.

Article 43: Concerning the crime of stealing another's territory and stealing annual tax

It is illegal to take annual tax or property from another person's territory without any reason, so the annual tax must be returned immediately. In addition, the possessions of those who do this will be confiscated. Those who do not have territory should be exiled. Additionally, land certificates issued in error will not be accepted. Such certificate must be promptly destroyed.

Article 44: Regarding third party desire to acquire property under trial

It is not permissible for a third party to make statements unfavorable to the parties concerned and try to incriminate them with the goal of receiving the disputed land. In court, statements made by anyone other than the parties involved will not be considered. Samurai can earn territory by working diligently.

Article 45: Prohibition of dismissal of defendant from office prior to judgment

The defendant may not be dismissed from office before the verdict is rendered. This is because he will be extremely dissatisfied regardless of whether he is guilty or not. Judgments must be given after careful consideration.

Article 46: Matters concerning the new Governor and the previous Governor at the time of change of Governor

It is the duty of the newly appointed national governor to collect taxes, but in doing so, he must not take away the personal belongings, cattle, horses, or retainers of his predecessor, nor bring shame upon him. However, this shall not apply if the predecessor has committed a crime and has been dismissed from office.

Article 47: Prohibition of donating documents of Shiranaga territory to others and Prohibition of head lords donating their territory to the Honjo without permission

Those who tried to effectively control territory by donating it to powerful people, even though they did not have effective control over it, were expelled, and those who received it were ordered to repair temples and shrines. Additionally, it is prohibited to donate territory to aristocrats or temples and shrines without permission from the Honjo. A village head who disobeys this rule is stripped of his position and placed under the jito. In places where there is no Jito, they are subordinate to the Honjo.

(This restrained the actual owner of the territory in which the land head dispatched from the shogunate resided, that is, the feudal head, from donating the territory to a more powerful

person without regard to the honjo to which the donation was made. This is a measure to prevent Jito from being at a disadvantage.)

Article 48: Prohibition of buying and selling territory

While there is no problem with the sale of the territory that a samurai has controlled for generations, it is forbidden to buy or sell land that has been granted by the Shogun as a reward. Those who violate this prohibition shall be punished both by the seller and the buyer.

Article 49: Regarding cases where judgment is rendered on the record of both parties

When the documents submitted by the plaintiff and the defendant can be examined and the reasonableness or wrongness can be clearly determined, a judgment shall be rendered directly without taking the trouble to summon both parties.

Article 50: Regarding Going to the Scene of a Violent Incident

When a violent incident occurs, it is permissible to go to investigate the details of the incident. However, it is punishable to go to the scene of a violent incident in order to join one side or the other.

Article 51: About scaring the accused with a letter of inquiry^(a)

It is a crime for a plaintiff to obtain a letter of interrogation issued to the defendant based on an accepted complaint and use its power to intimidate the defendant. From now on, we will examine complaints and will no longer issue letters of inquiry in response to unreasonable complaints.

- a) Letter of inquiry = A document containing the questions to ask the other party in court.

(This provision was added because in the past, the plaintiff often used the authority of the shogunate to intimidate the defendant even after the complaint was accepted.)